



PCLinuxOS 2010 out

OSNews has an interview with Texstar, the founder of the PCLinuxOS project, and a review of the default KDE edition, at <http://bit.ly/bIgXe0>. Other editions are available for download at pclinuxos.com. Though PCLinuxOS' goal is to maintain a rolling release as long as the underlying software permits, because of major changes and a new framework, the 2010 release requires a complete reinstall instead of a rolling upgrade.

Features include: kernel 2.6.32.11-bfs for maximum desktop performance; full KDE 4.4.2 desktop; Nvidia and ATI fgfrx driver support; Addlocale allows you to convert PCLinuxOS into over 60 languages; GetOpenOffice can install Open Office supporting over 100 languages; MyLiveCD allows you to take a snapshot of your installation and burn it to a LiveCD/DVD; and Parental Controls to keep your kids away from those naughty websites.

PCLinuxOS 2010 includes the latest popular applications like Firefox 3.6.3, Thunderbird 3.0.4, Dropbox for online backup storage, Pidgin 2.6.6, KTorrent, the GIMP, Digikam, Amarok, SMPlayer, plus over 12,000 additional packages in the software repository. It does not, however, ship Win32codecs or

libdvdcss2 software. More at: <http://bit.ly/3xb0Kx>.

OpenStreetMap crosses 250,000 contributors

The OpenStreetMap (OSM) Project is building free user-contributed online maps of the whole world, using GPS traces. All data is released with an open content licence. OSM recently crossed 250,000 registered users around April 19, 2010. Founded in August 2004 by Steve Coast, it is run by the OpenStreetMap Foundation and has grown increasingly popular over the last year—1,00,000 registered users in March 2009; 2,00,000 users in early January this year... More at <http://bit.ly/9r5vt1> and <http://bit.ly/UCd14>.

Fedora 13 'Goddard' set to launch in mid-May

Currently in beta release, Fedora 13's list of key new features includes: automatic printer driver installation; desktop experience enhancements; better mobile broadband, Bluetooth, and new CLI abilities; colour management through the `gnome-color-manager` package; enhanced iPod functionality via `libimobiledevice`; experimental 3D graphics support extended to free Nouveau driver for Nvidia cards; DisplayPort support improvements; and an experimental user management interface.

For developers, there are: SystemTap static probes; easier Python debugging; the parallel-installable Python 3 stack; and NetBeans Java EE 6 support.

And for system administrators, there is: `boot.fedoraproject.org` (BFO); System Security Services Daemon (SSSD); pioneering NFS features; Zafra Open Source edition Groupware (alternative to MS Exchange); Btrfs snapshots integration; Dogtag Certificate System, etc. See <http://bit.ly/bd1YG0> for the full announcement, download link, the known bugs link, and more.



FOSS mail filtering framework spmfilter released

Munich-based SpaceNet AG has released (under the LGPL) `spmfilter`, an open source programming framework for content and spam filtering modules. `Spmfilter` is a high-performance mail filtering framework written in C. Filtering mechanisms are provided by plug-ins; the API enables `spmfilter` plug-ins to access messages as they are being processed by the MTA, allowing them to examine and modify message content and meta-information during the SMTP transaction. Plug-ins are loaded at runtime and can be processed in any sequence. The processing chain can also be altered by a single plugin—for example, stopping further processing if the `clamav`-plugin detected malicious software.

You can use `spmfilter`, which has its own generic SMTP engine, with any MTA. It supports connections to multiple database back-ends (PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite, BerkeleyDB and LDAP) with connection pooling, failover and load balancing. Coding failures (for example, core dumps) in a plugin will not stop mail delivery; the MTA receives a 4xx SMTP error code, causing the mail to be queued for later processing. Downloads, documentation and more are available at: <http://bit.ly/dpSPRI>.

RT-Thread OS 0.3.0 out

RT-Thread RTOS is an open source (under Apache License 2.0) real-time operating system for 16-bit and 32-bit microcontrollers, developed by the RT-Thread Studio based in China. Components include a hard real-time kernel, a command-line shell, a device virtual file system, and a GUI. More at: <http://bit.ly/9iK7WS>.